

The most exciting part of owning a credit card has plenty of options: cashbacks, miles, reward points that can be redeemed for gifts. Often you will hear stories with cashbacks of 5000 on monthly spend of 60,000 or even more in some instances. Getting caught up in the haywires of reward options is often overwhelming and choosing a card can be a long drawn out process. But if this will be your first credit card application, it is a '*credit building card*'. The decision can be quite straight-forward.

Forego the importance to rewards and get a card with a high limit so that you'll only be utilizing 50% of the limit. That way, your credit-score will remain high irrespective of having just one source of credit. Citibank Premier Miles is an ideal card for first timers while ICICI Instant Platinum Card runs a close second [\[9\]](#). Look them up, research your needs and choose between the two. Getting approved is a task but it helps if your company deposits the salary into an ICICI account or you have a FD open with them. Right now, if you're thinking, "*Really, a FD? Are you kidding me?*" you wouldn't be alone. Bear in mind, the rewards of building a credit line far outweigh the opportunity cost of having 1lakh in a FD for a couple of years. Plus, you could use this 1lakh as your safety net, in case you lose your job (explained in Week 4). So suck up, find a lakh from your parents or save some money and get your first credit card.

When it comes to a secondary card, people have different strategies. Some choose multiple cards in their wallet as they like to utilize each card's specialized benefits. I prefer one secondary card with a high credit limit. I know that I'm not getting the optimal usage of rewards, but I prefer to 80/20 the credit building process and having more than 2 cards is just too much work. The credit report will only have one source of two credit cards and that isn't bad. At least the credit score will be very high and that feels like a bullet in my gun during negotiations. At best, I will be quoted 0.5% more when I request for car loans as compared to someone who has multiple sources of credit (personal loans, credit cards, etc.)

For secondary cards, hit up Cashoverflow.in's post on the '*Best credit cards in India*'. Pardeep updates it yearly and he has a good pulse on the best options around. As a consensus, Standard Chartered Manhattan Card is widely used along with HDFC Regalia. Oh, and since you're looking at